LIVE SHOPPING SEARCH INSIGHTS

Live Shopping in the United States

A 2026 Search-Interest Report: the breakout, the platforms, and what is driving the trend

Alex Papageorgiou

June 2026

EXECUTIVE OVERVIEW

US live shopping has moved from a post-pandemic slump to a genuine breakout. After Meta retired its native live-shopping features in 2022-23, category search interest drifted lower and bottomed in mid-2024. It then inflected sharply: average monthly search interest rose roughly 49% in 2025, and the single largest spike on record lined up with the January 2025 US TikTok ban drama. This report builds live-shopping and live-selling search indices from a fresh pull of ~80,000 keywords (Google Ads Keyword Planner, June 2022 - May 2026, US only) and examines the category from many angles: a platform-rotation and share-of-search view, the rise (and fall) of category-native challengers, the trading-card-led vertical story, a lead-lag test showing sellers move first, and an empirical look at trust ("is it legit?") and how the category's questions are maturing.

Contents

Executive summary ... 3
Twelve things that surprised us ... 4
Introduction and method ... 5
What we measure ... 5
How the data is built ... 5
The headline: a trough, then a breakout ... 6
What drove the inflection ... 7
The January 2025 spike as a natural experiment ... 7
When live shopping happens: seasonality ... 9
The supply side leads: live selling ... 10
Sellers as a leading indicator - quantified ... 11
Platform rotation ... 12
The rotation, in shares ... 13
Home shopping's quiet reinvention: QVC and HSN ... 15
Whatnot: the defining company of the cycle ... 16
The challengers ... 17

When they arrived - and who survived ... 18
Platform profiles: a field guide ... 19
What is growing fastest ... 21
Micro-trends: spotlights from the long tail ... 22
What people ask ... 22
Shoppers and sellers compare platforms ... 22
Tools, apps and “how do I go live” ... 22
Trading cards and “breaks”: the collectibles engine, in miniature ... 23
Niche breakouts: plants and thrift go live ... 23
The wave is home-grown, not imported ... 23
Whatnot’s long tail ... 24
How the questions mature ... 24
Trust: “is it legit?” ... 26
Vertical breakouts ... 26
Live auctions: a parallel format ... 28
The long tail: where tomorrow’s trends hide ... 28
Where the opportunities are ... 29
Beyond search: corroborating signals and global context ... 30
Risks: what could derail the breakout ... 30
What it means - by stakeholder ... 31
For platforms and marketplaces ... 31
For incumbent retailers and brands ... 31
For sellers and creators ... 31
For investors and analysts ... 31
What search data can - and cannot - tell you ... 31
Outlook and implications ... 33
A watchlist for 2026-27 ... 33
Appendix ... 35
Methodology details ... 35
The data funnel ... 35
The index basket ... 36
Glossary ... 36
Caveats ... 36
Selected sources ... 36

Executive summary

- **The category broke out in 2025.** Average monthly US search interest across a basket of 188+ live-shopping queries rose about **49% in 2025 versus 2024** (from roughly 5,840 to 8,680 indexed monthly searches), after two years of post-Meta decline that bottomed in mid-2024.
- **The single biggest spike is event-driven.** The index hit its peak in **January 2025** (more than 2.2x the June-2022 baseline), coinciding with the US TikTok ban drama and brief outage. Interest did not collapse afterwards - it settled onto a structurally higher plateau through 2025 and into 2026.
- **Whatnot is the defining company of this cycle.** Brand search for “whatnot” has grown roughly **7x in three years**; it is by far the fastest-growing live-shopping query. Whatnot reported **~$6B+ GMV in 2025** (with ~$8B in live GMV cited) and raised **$225M at an $11.5B valuation** in October 2025 - double its value at the start of the year.
- **A wave of category-native challengers has arrived.** Search interest is climbing for **Fanatics Live**, **eBay Live**, and **Palmstreet**, while **StockX Live** launches in summer 2026. The hype-driven drops model (NTWRK) is fading.
- **The supply side runs hotter than the demand side.** The **live-selling** index has more than doubled since 2022 (index ~246), and seller-intent queries - “how to sell on Whatnot”, “TikTok Shop seller center”, “whatnot seller fees” - are among the fastest growers. Sellers are a leading indicator.
- **Trust is the gating question.** “Is it legit?” searches scale with adoption. TikTok Shop legitimacy fears spiked after its 2023 US launch and then eased; **“is whatnot legit”** has climbed steadily and now leads, a natural by-product of mainstream growth.
- **Collectibles still lead, but the mix is broadening.** Trading cards / breaks dominate live-shopping vertical search (+135% over the window), while Whatnot’s own reporting shows beauty, electronics, jewelry and women’s fashion as its fastest-growing GMV categories.

Twelve things that surprised us

A quick-reference of the less-obvious findings in this report - the things industry insiders may not already know:

1. The famous **January 2025 spike was mostly a flash** - only ~13% of the jump persisted.
2. …but it left a **real ~18% lift** in the baseline. Distinguish the flash from the floor.
3. **Live-selling search leads live-shopping search by ~6 months** - a usable leading indicator.
4. **15,000+** QVC/HSN keywords surfaced organically - the “home shopping vs. live shopping” academic distinction has collapsed in practice.
5. QVC/HSN’s **legacy terms decline while “official site”/app terms rise** - the audience is migrating screen-to-screen, not disappearing.
6. **NTWRK collapsed ~96%** from its peak - hype-driven drops are rented; community is owned.
7. **Palmstreet** (live plant/ceramics selling) broke out from near-zero in mid-2024 - the new-entrant pipeline is open.
8. The US wave is **home-grown**: interest in Chinese super-apps (Douyin, Taobao Live) is negligible as *shopping* intent.
9. **“How do I do it” now outranks “what is it” and “is it legit”** - the market has shifted from awareness to participation.
10. The category is **rotating, not consolidating** - the concentration index rose only mildly.
11. **Brand search is escaping the category vocabulary** - people search “whatnot,” not “whatnot live shopping.”
12. **Trading cards lead live-shopping vertical search, but beauty leads the GMV growth** (+791% on Whatnot) - the on-ramp and the money are different verticals.

Introduction and method

Live shopping - real-time, video-led commerce where a host sells to a live audience that can buy, bid, and chat in the moment - has been “about to happen” in the US for years. In China it is mature (an estimated ~60% of e-commerce involves live formats); in the US it has hovered around ~5% of e-commerce. The question for 2026 is whether the US has finally turned the corner. Search behaviour is a useful, unbiased leading signal: it captures demand before it shows up in GMV, and it captures supply-side intent (people learning to sell) before sellers are onboarded.

What we measure

We track **search interest** - how often Americans search Google for live-shopping-related terms - as a proxy for category attention. Two indices are built:

- **Live Shopping index** - consumer-facing queries (e.g. *live shopping*, *tiktok live shopping*, *whatnot live shopping*, *live commerce*).
- **Live Selling index** - seller-oriented queries (e.g. *live selling*, *how to sell on whatnot*, *tiktok live selling*).

How the data is built

Starting from ~7,700 curated seed terms covering established and emerging live-shopping platforms and verticals, we expanded them via the Google Ads Keyword Planner API into a universe of **~257,000 raw keyword ideas**, de-duplicated to **~79,000 unique keywords** with complete monthly histories. The window is **June 2022 - May 2026 (48 months), US and English only.** Each index sums monthly search volume across its keyword basket and is normalized so the first month = 100. Charts show a 3-month moving average to suppress month-to-month noise; the thin grey line is the raw monthly series.

A note on the data: every number here comes from **one fresh pull** with no spliced-in historical volumes, so the series is internally consistent. Known bot-inflated terms are excluded. This is a US-only report; international markets are out of scope by design.

The headline: a trough, then a breakout

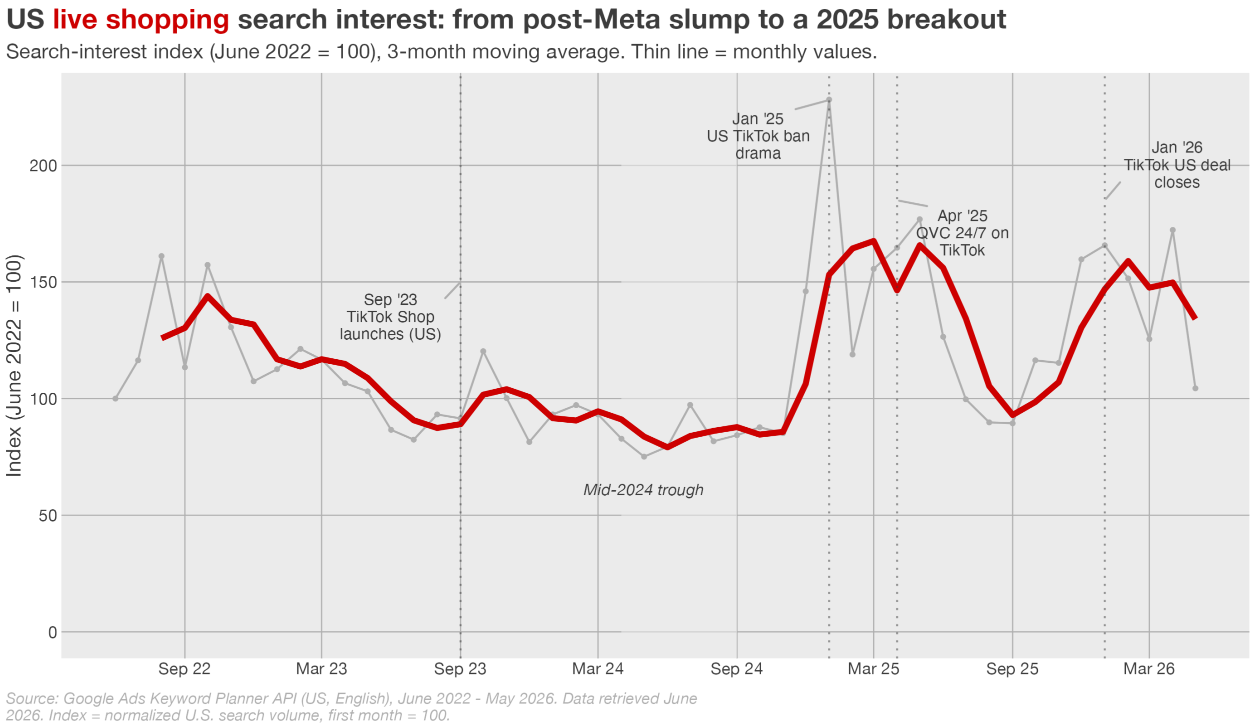

Figure 1: US live-shopping search interest, June 2022 - May 2026. The category declined after Meta exited live shopping, bottomed in mid-2024, then broke out - peaking around the January 2025 US TikTok ban drama and holding a higher plateau since.

The shape of Figure 1 is the story of the whole report. Three phases stand out:

1. **Drift and decline (2022 - mid-2024).** Meta's retreat from native live shopping - Facebook live shopping ended in 2022, Instagram's in early 2023 - removed the most visible on-ramp for mainstream US consumers. Interest drifted down and reached its **lowest point in mid-2024**.
2. **The inflection (late 2024 - early 2025).** Interest turned up sharply in Q4 2024 and **peaked in January 2025**, when the US TikTok ban saga and brief app-store outage put social commerce on every front page. This is the clearest example in the data of an external event moving the category.
3. **A higher plateau (2025 - 2026).** Crucially, interest did **not** revert to the 2024 trough. It settled onto a visibly higher band, with seasonal peaks (holiday quarters) now towering over the old baseline. Average monthly interest in 2025 was about **49% above 2024**.

The deeper point is the floor, not the ceiling: this reads as a **regime change** rather than a temporary bounce - the baseline has moved up, not just the seasonal peaks.

What drove the inflection

Search interest rarely moves on its own. Overlaying the index against the live-shopping news cycle, a handful of events align with the turns in Figure 1:

When	Event	Effect on search
Aug 2022 / Mar 2023	Meta ends Facebook / Instagram live shopping	Removes a mainstream on-ramp; interest drifts down
Sep 2023	TikTok Shop launches in the US	Re-seeds the category; stabilizes interest
Jan 2025	US TikTok ban drama + brief outage	Largest single spike on record
Feb 2025	Qurate rebrands to QVC Group ("live social shopping company")	Legacy TV shopping repositions around live
Apr 2025	QVC launches a 24/7 live channel on TikTok	Reinforces the TikTok-as-storefront narrative
Oct 2025	Whatnot raises $225M at an $11.5B valuation	Validates the category for investors and press
Jan 2026	TikTok US "USDS" joint venture closes (ban resolved)	Removes the existential overhang for the biggest social storefront

The throughline is **TikTok**. Its 2023 launch re-seeded US live commerce; its 2025 political drama supplied the demand shock; and the January 2026 ownership resolution (ByteDance below 20%, an Oracle / Silver Lake / MGX-led group holding the majority) removed the tail risk that had hung over the single largest social storefront. TikTok Shop's own scale underlines why this matters: **US GMV grew from ~$9B in 2024 to ~$15B in 2025**, and the number of US sellers exploded from ~4,450 in mid-2023 to ~475,000 by mid-2025.

The January 2025 spike as a natural experiment

The TikTok ban drama is, in effect, a natural experiment: a sudden, exogenous shock to attention, after which we can measure what stuck. Decomposing the index around it is revealing, and a little humbling for anyone tempted to read every spike as a step-change:

- **The spike was huge but mostly transient.** January 2025 reached an index of **228 - about 2.4x** the trailing six-month average (Jul-Dec 2024 ≈ 97). That is a genuine attention shock.
- **Most of it washed out.** Averaging the post-spike plateau (Jun-Dec 2025 ≈ 114) against the pre-spike base shows the category **retained only ~13% of the jump.** The flashbulb faded.

- **But the residue is real.** That same plateau still sits **~18% above the pre-spike base** - a permanent lift, not a full reversion. And it arrived alongside the *structural* changes (QVC on TikTok, Whatnot's raise, new entrants) that the shock helped catalyse.

The lesson for reading this category: distinguish the **flash** from the **floor.** Event spikes are mostly transient; the durable signal is the slow, unglamorous rise in the baseline - which is exactly what the moving average in Figure 1 isolates.

When live shopping happens: seasonality

Beyond the long-run trend, the category has a distinct **annual rhythm** (Figure 2). Stripping out the level and averaging each calendar month across the window shows interest concentrating in two periods: the **holiday quarter** (October-December, when gifting and deal-hunting peak) and a secondary **late-winter/ spring** bump.

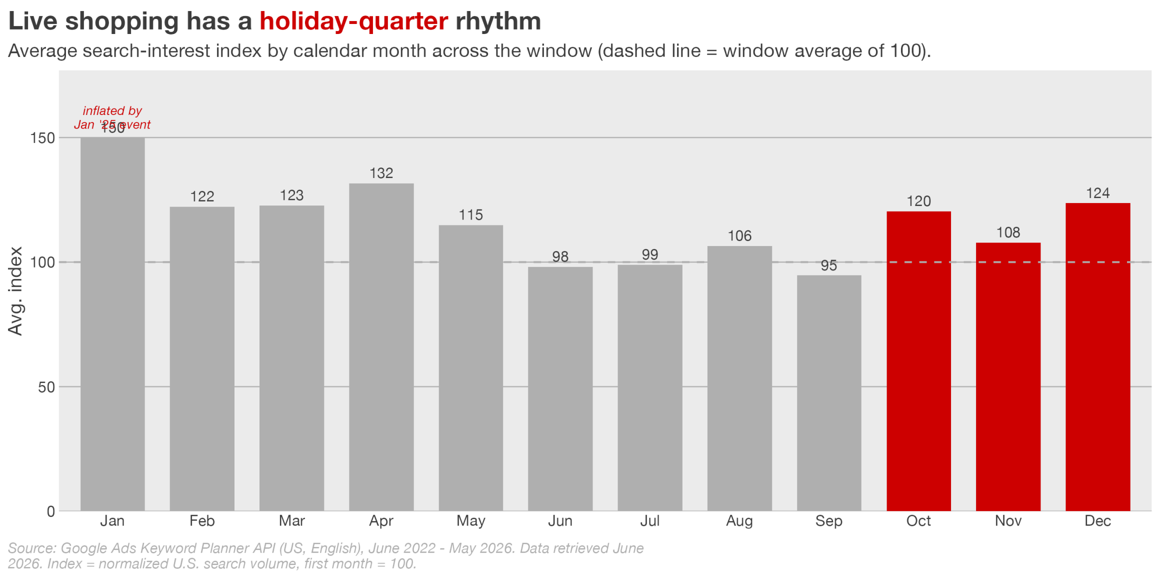

Figure 2: Average search-interest index by calendar month. Live shopping concentrates in the holiday quarter; the January figure is inflated by the one-off 2025 TikTok-ban spike.

Two caveats make this more interesting than a simple "holidays are big" story. First, the towering **January** average is largely an artefact of the one-off 2025 TikTok-ban spike rather than a recurring seasonal feature - a good reminder that event shocks and seasonality can be confounded. Second, the summer trough (June-September) is shallow and rising year on year, which is consistent with the category becoming a **year-round habit** rather than a purely gift-driven one. For sellers and platforms, the practical read is that the calendar still rewards a Q4 push, but the off-season floor is where the structural growth is showing up.

The supply side leads: live selling

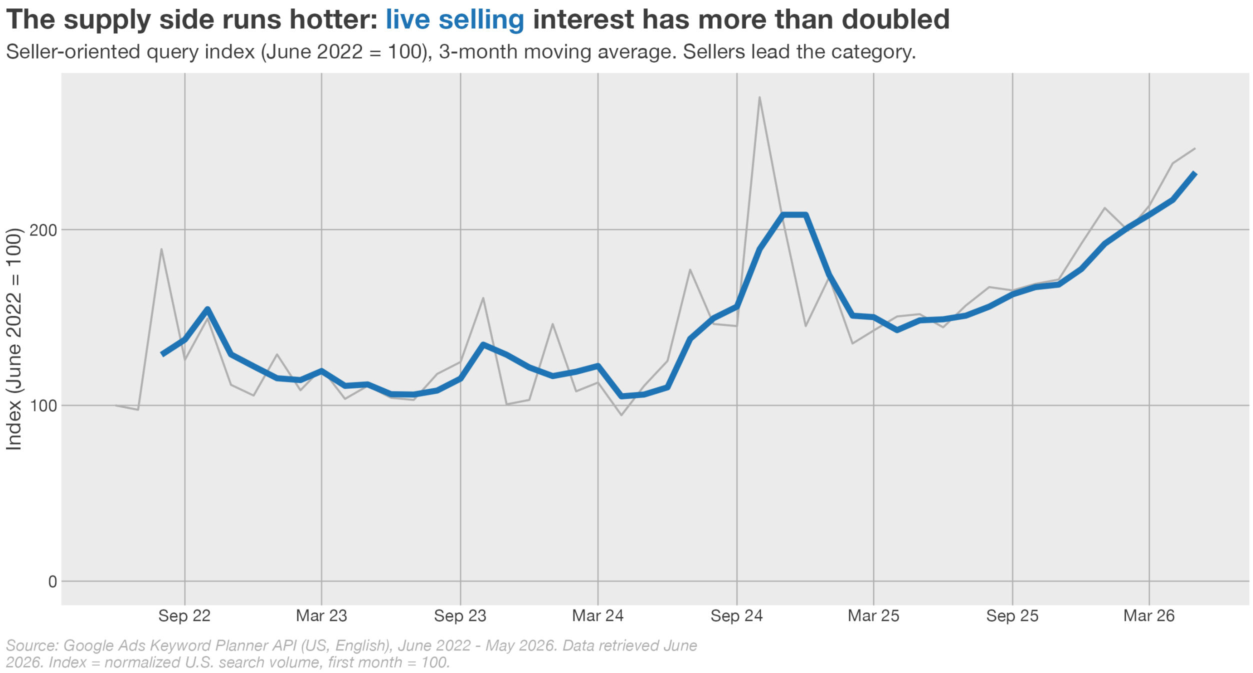

Figure 3: The live-selling (seller-intent) index has more than doubled since 2022, outpacing the consumer-facing live-shopping index.

One of the most reliable patterns in the data is that **sellers move first**. The live-selling index (Figure 3) has more than doubled since 2022 and sits well above the consumer index in relative terms. Seller-intent queries are also disproportionately represented among the fastest-growing terms overall: *how to sell on whatnot*, *tiktok shop seller center*, *tiktok shop affiliate program*, *whatnot seller fees*.

Why this matters: live commerce is a two-sided market, and supply is the constraint. A surge in people learning **how to sell** is a leading indicator that the next wave of inventory, hosts, and content is being created now - which tends to pull consumer interest up behind it. The signal-to-noise on the selling side is also higher: nobody idly searches “whatnot seller fees” - that is someone with a business plan.

A sample of the seller-learning vocabulary makes the point concrete. These are not high-volume head terms; they are the quiet, high-intent queries of people deciding to become live sellers.

Table 1: Sample of seller-intent queries. The full universe contains ~100 distinct “how to sell”-style live-shopping terms.

Keyword	Avg. monthly searches	4-yr trend
tiktok shop seller center	18,100	up
how to sell on tiktok shop	4,400	up
how to sell on whatnot	2,900	up
whatnot seller fees	1,600	up
how to start a tiktok shop	1,000	flat
whatnot seller	880	flat
how to start selling on whatnot	260	flat

Sellers as a leading indicator - quantified

The claim that “sellers move first” is testable, not just intuitive. If we correlate the month-over-month change in the live-selling index against the live-shopping index at a range of time offsets (Figure 4), the correlation peaks where **selling leads shopping by roughly six months.** In other words, a surge in people learning to sell tends to show up about two quarters *before* the corresponding rise in consumer-side interest.

Figure 4: Correlation between the two indices’ month-over-month changes at different lags. The peak on the “selling leads” side means seller interest is an early-warning signal for the category.

The relationship is moderate, not deterministic (the category is noisy and event-driven), but the direction is consistent and intuitive: live commerce is supply-constrained, so the people building the next wave of inventory and content move before the audience does. For anyone trying to time the category - investors, platforms, brands - **the live-selling index is the more useful leading dashboard**, even though it is smaller and quieter than the consumer index.

Platform rotation

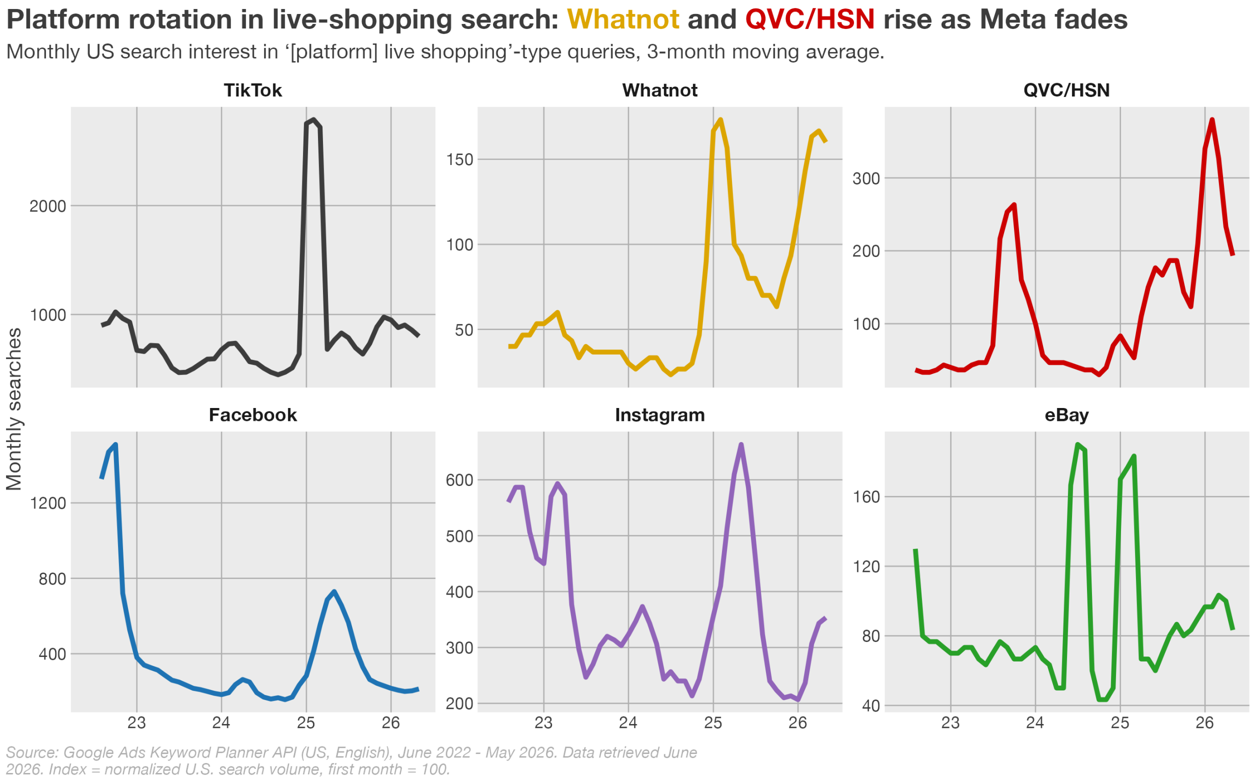

Figure 5: Live-shopping search interest by platform (queries of the form "[platform] live shopping"), 3-month moving average. Whatnot and QVC/HSN trend up; Meta's surfaces fade; TikTok dominates and spikes with the 2025 news cycle.

When we slice live-shopping queries by the platform named in them (Figure 5), a clear **rotation** appears:

- **TikTok** dominates in absolute terms and shows the January 2025 spike most violently - it is the lightning rod for category attention.
- **Whatnot** and **QVC/HSN** are the two clear up-and-to-the-right trends. QVC/HSN is the more surprising of the two: a 40-year-old TV-shopping incumbent is being **re-discovered through a live-social lens**, helped by its 2025 rebrand and its 24/7 TikTok channel.
- **Facebook and Instagram** fade steadily - the long tail of Meta's 2022-23 exit.
- **eBay** is volatile but present, buoyed by eBay Live's expansion into collectibles, watches, and handbags.

The strategic read: the category is **not** consolidating onto one app. TikTok is the top-of-funnel attention engine, Whatnot is the category-native destination, and QVC/HSN shows that incumbents can re-platform onto live-social rather than be displaced by it - even as the parent company restructures (QVC Group filed a prepackaged Chapter 11 in April 2026 to cut debt while pursuing its live-social "WIN" strategy).

The rotation, in shares

Looking at *shares* rather than levels makes the rotation unmistakable (Figure 6). Among branded "[platform] live shopping" searches, **Whatnot climbed from roughly 1% to ~8%** of the pie, and QVC/HSN gained, while Facebook and Instagram surrendered share they had held since the pandemic.

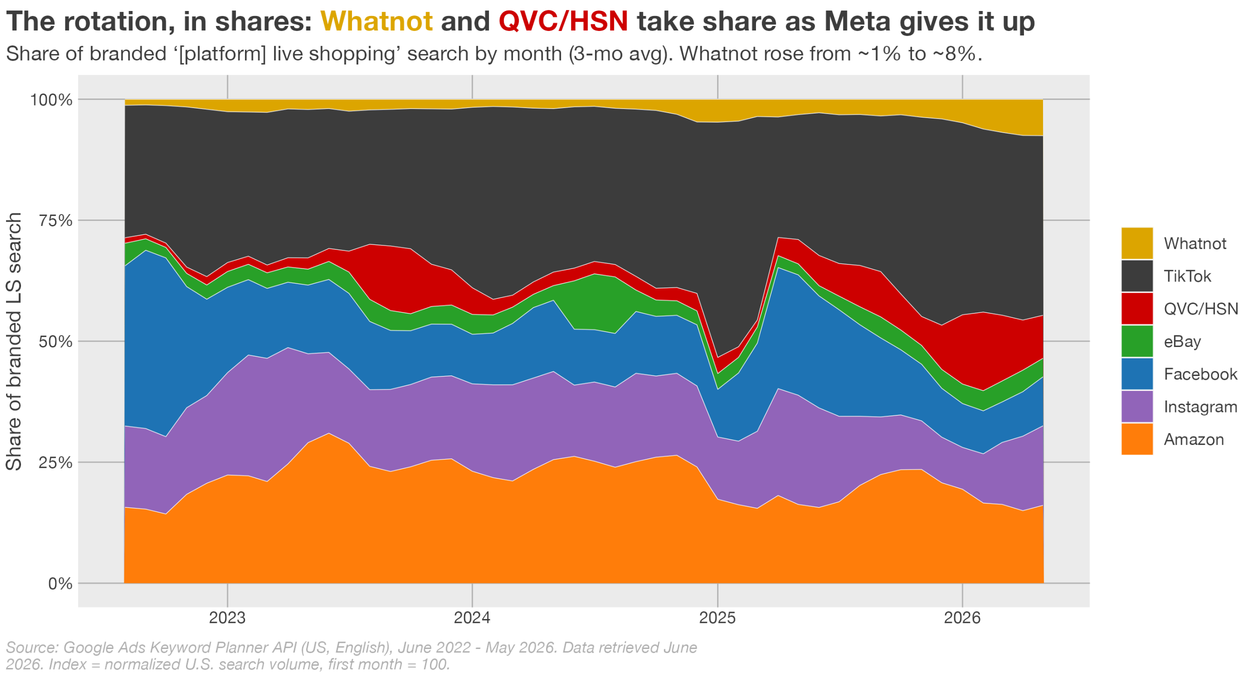

Figure 6: Share of branded '[platform] live shopping' search by month. Whatnot and QVC/HSN gain share; Meta's surfaces give it up.

Two structural caveats make this more interesting than a simple horse race:

- **The category is mildly concentrating, not consolidating.** A Herfindahl index of branded live-shopping search rose only modestly (from ~1,770 to ~2,040 over the window) - still well below levels that would signal a single winner. The market is **rotating attention between many players**, not collapsing onto one. Figure 7 shows the other side of that coin: Whatnot's own slice of branded live-shopping search climbed from a rounding error to a meaningful share over the window.
- **The brand energy is escaping the "live shopping" phrasing entirely.** Within explicit "live shopping" queries, the *branded* share actually fell (from ~40% to ~31%) as Meta's terms collapsed. But that understates the brands, because the real brand search has migrated to *standalone names* - people now simply search "**whatnot**", not "whatnot live shopping." When a platform becomes a verb, it leaves the category's generic vocabulary behind. That migration - from concept search to brand search - is itself a marker of the category maturing.

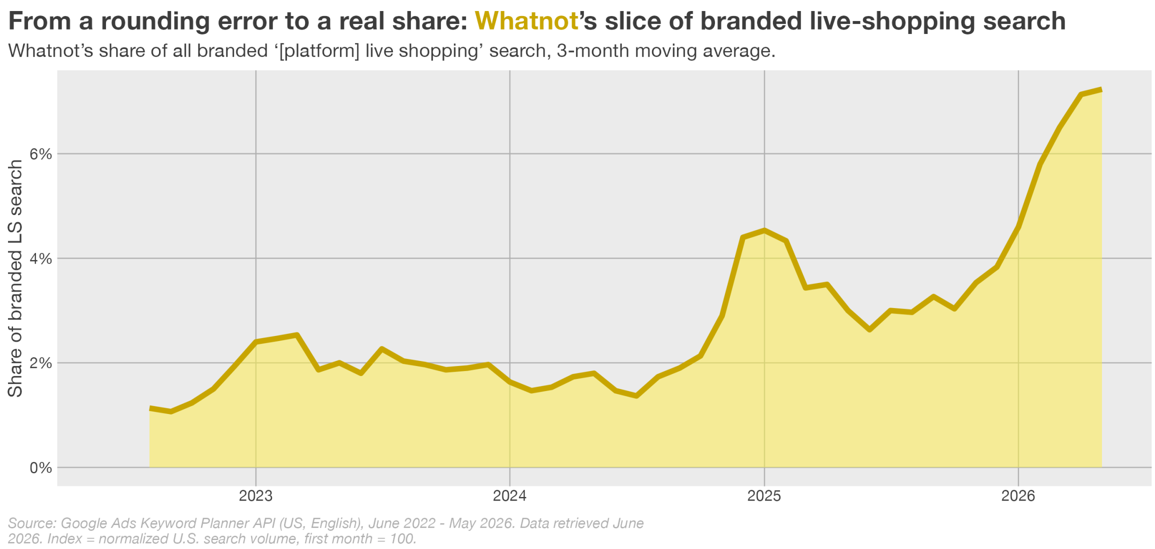

Figure 7: Whatnot's share of all branded '[platform] live shopping' search over time (3-mo avg).

Home shopping's quiet reinvention: QVC and HSN

One of the most surprising findings is how **enormous the QVC/HSN footprint is** inside an organically-grown live-shopping keyword set. The seed universe was expanded using Google's own "related terms" suggestions, so the keywords that surface are the ones Google associates with live shopping in practice. On that basis, **more than 15,000** of our keywords relate to QVC or HSN - literally thousands of distinct queries.

This matters because the academic literature has long drawn a line between *live shopping* (social, creator-led, interactive) and *home shopping networks* (broadcast TV retail). Google's association data quietly erases that line: in the market's mental model, QVC and HSN **are** live shopping. That is the "academic conclusions vs. market reality" gap in one statistic.

Table 2: A small sample of the 15,000+ QVC/HSN-related queries in the universe.

Keyword	Avg. monthly searches	4-yr trend
qvc	3,350,000	down
hsn	1,000,000	down
qvc com official site	201,000	up
qvc live	40,500	down
qvc tv live	40,500	down
hsn official site	9,900	up
qvc com official site shopping online	12,100	up
hsn app	2,400	flat

The trend split inside Table 2 is the real story. The **legacy brand terms are declining** (*qvc*, *hsn*, *qvc tv live*) - the old TV-shopping habit is fading - while **"official site", "app" and "shopping online" variants are rising.** A 40-year-old audience is migrating from the TV set to the website and the app, exactly as QVC Group's strategy intends.

The corporate moves line up with the search data:

- **Feb 2025:** Qurate Retail rebrands as **QVC Group**, explicitly to become a "live social shopping company."
- **Apr 2025:** QVC launches the first **24/7 live-shopping channel on TikTok** in the US.
- **Apr 2026:** QVC Group files a **prepackaged Chapter 11** to cut debt while pursuing its live-social "WIN" strategy.

The open question is whether a broadcast-era brand can convince a social-era audience. The data says the transition is real and underway; whether it is *enough* - and whether it wins genuinely new audiences rather than just retaining the old one online - is the thing to watch. It is the clearest test in the market of whether incumbents can re-platform onto live-social rather than be displaced by it.

Whatnot: the defining company of the cycle

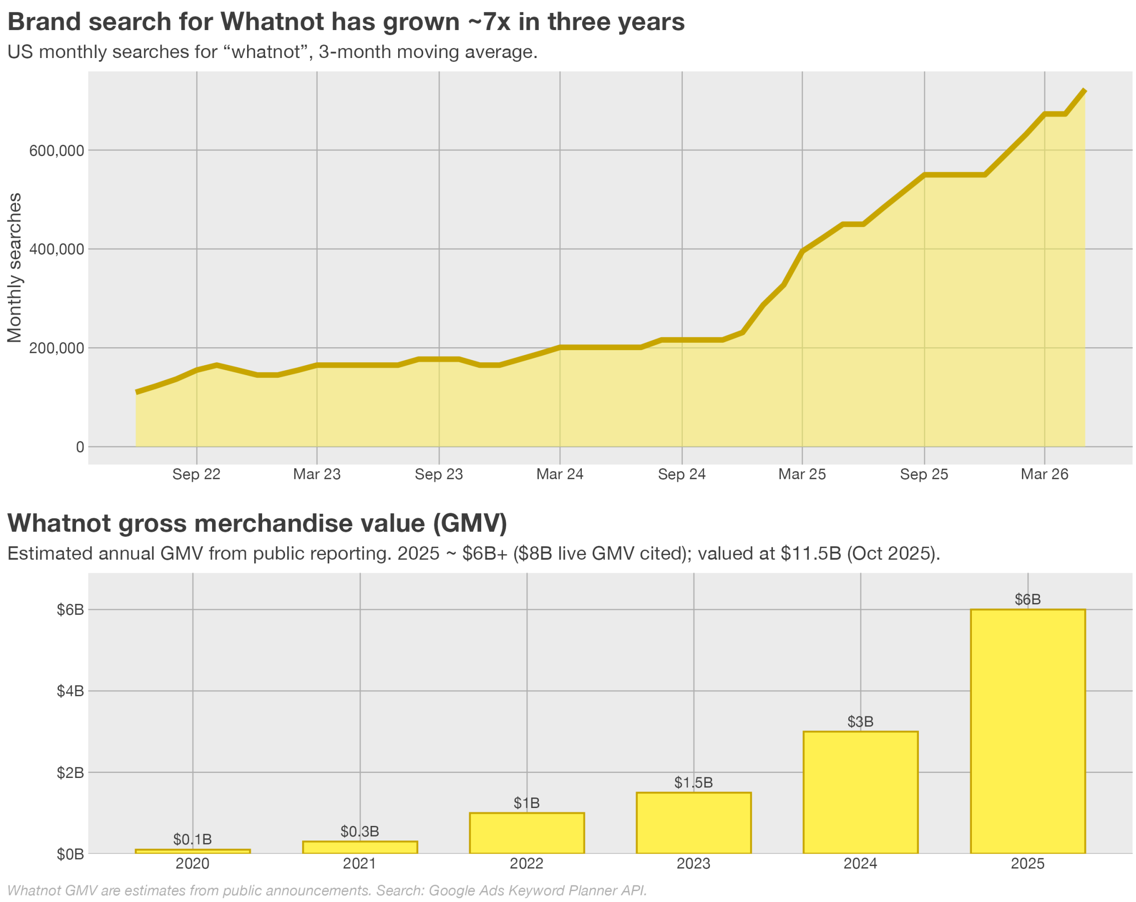

Figure 8: Top: US brand search for "whatnot" has grown roughly 7x since 2022. Bottom: estimated Whatnot GMV, ~$0.1B (2020) to ~$6B+ (2025).

If 2025 has a protagonist, it is **Whatnot**. By every angle in the data it is the strongest trend in live shopping:

- **Search:** brand interest is up ~7x in three years (Figure 8, top) and "whatnot" is the single fastest-growing live-shopping query by a wide margin.
- **GMV:** roughly **$0.1B (2020) -> $1.5B (2023) -> $3B (2024) -> $6B+ (2025)**, with the company citing ~$8B in live GMV and revenue approaching $1B. Growth has been close to 2x a year.
- **Capital:** a **$225M round at an $11.5B valuation** in October 2025 (DST Global and CapitalG leading; Sequoia, a16z, Greycroft, BOND participating), roughly double the start-of-year mark; ~$968M raised since 2019.
- **Engagement:** ~80-95 minutes per active user per day, >80% month-over-month retention, and new buyers up ~285% year on year. It ranked the **#1 shopping app in both the US and UK** in 2025 and did **$100M+ in live sales on Black Friday alone**.

The open question for any company growing this fast is whether it can keep doubling. The 2025 data says yes: it both **doubled GMV and re-rated in the private markets**, while broadening from its collectibles roots into 140+ categories. The risk is no longer demand - it is whether supply (sellers, moderation, fulfillment, trust) can scale with it.

So what is actually driving it? The data cannot fully answer the "why", but it points at the ingredients worth studying:

- **Community over catalogue.** Whatnot grew out of a passionate collectibles community (cards, Funko, sneakers) where the live format mirrors how those hobbies already work - drops, breaks, banter, and the thrill of the hunt. Engagement of ~80-95 minutes a day looks more like a social network than a store.
- **Niche-first, then broaden.** It owned a vertical before chasing everything, then used that trust and habit to expand into beauty, fashion and electronics - the categories now scaling fastest by GMV.
- **Format and trust infrastructure.** Native auctions, buyer protection, and seller tooling turn a chaotic livestream into a transactable marketplace. The fact that "*is whatnot legit*" is a top-growing query (see the *Trust* section) is, paradoxically, a sign the format has reached the skeptical mainstream.

The strategic lesson for the rest of the industry: live shopping in the US did not take off as a generic "video + cart" feature bolted onto existing apps - it took off where a real community already wanted to gather and trade.

The challengers

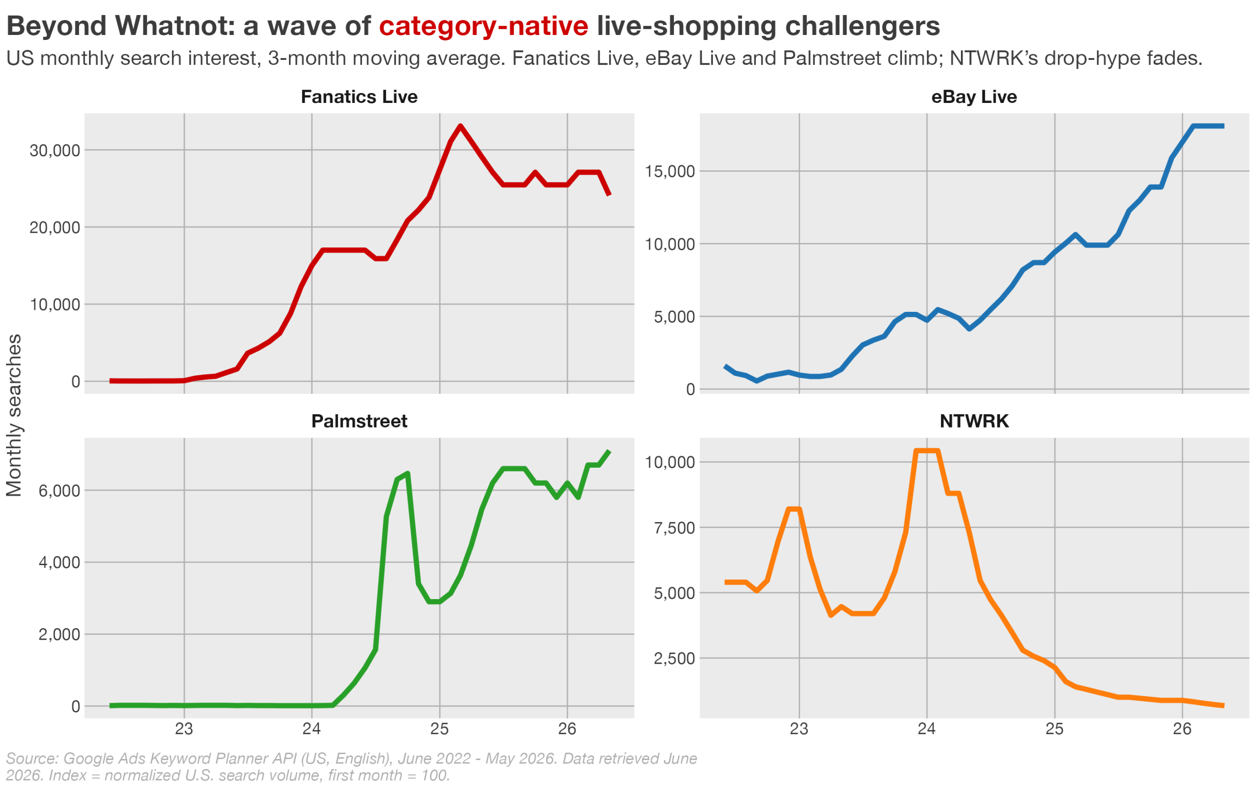

Figure 9: Category-native live-shopping challengers. Fanatics Live, eBay Live and Palmstreet are climbing; NTWRK's drops-driven model is fading.

Whatnot is not alone. A cohort of **category-native** platforms is gaining search traction (Figure 9), each owning a vertical rather than chasing "everything live":

- **Fanatics Live** - trading cards and sports collectibles, leveraging Fanatics' licensing and "breaks" culture. The clearest challenger uptrend.
- **eBay Live** - cards and collectibles first, now luxury watches, handbags and fashion; expanding to Germany and Canada in 2026.
- **Palmstreet** - a genuine surprise: a niche live marketplace (plants, ceramics, niche collectibles) breaking out from near zero in 2024 to a durable base.
- **StockX Live** - announced for **summer 2026** (sneakers, apparel, cards, vintage); too new to register in search yet, but one to watch.
- **NTWRK** - the celebrity/drops model has **faded** from its 2023-24 peak, a reminder that hype-driven formats are harder to sustain than community-driven ones.

When they arrived - and who survived

Dating each challenger's first month of meaningful search adds a time dimension to the story - and a cautionary tale about churn:

Table 3: Emergence and survival of live-shopping challengers.

Platform	First meaningful search	Peak monthly	Latest	Status
Whatnot	Jun 2022 (already rising)	823,000	823,000	At/near peak
eBay Live	May 2023	18,100	18,100	At/near peak
Fanatics Live	Jul 2023	33,100	18,100	Off peak, durable
Palmstreet	Jun 2024	12,100	6,600	Newest breakout
NTWRK	(early)	14,800	590	Collapsed (-96%)
StockX Live	not yet	-	-	Launches summer 2026

The standout in Table 3 is **NTWRK's collapse - down roughly 96% from its peak.** The celebrity-drops model burned bright in 2023-24 and then faded fast, a sharp contrast with the community-driven platforms that have held or grown. It is the clearest evidence in the data for the report's recurring thesis: **hype is rented, community is owned.** Palmstreet, emerging only in mid-2024, shows the pipeline of new entrants is still very much open.

The pattern is telling: the winners are **community-and-category-native** (Whatnot, Fanatics, Palmstreet), not generic "live video + cart" tools. Owning a passionate vertical beats owning a feature.

Platform profiles: a field guide

The US live-shopping landscape is best understood not as one market but as a **federation of lanes**. The table below maps the main players by their model and primary vertical, with a read on where each sits in the search data.

Table 4: The US live-shopping field, by model and vertical.

Platform	Model	Primary vertical(s)	Search signal
TikTok Shop	Social feed + live	Beauty, fashion, gadgets	Dominant; spikes with news
Whatnot	Live marketplace + auctions	Collectibles, then beauty/ fashion	Strongest grower (~7x)
QVC / HSN	Broadcast + streaming + social	Beauty, fashion, home, jewelry	Huge base; re-platforming
Fanatics Live	Live + card breaks	Sports cards, collectibles	Clear uptrend
eBay Live	Live auctions	Cards, watches, handbags, fashion	Rising, expanding geos
Amazon Live	Influencer streams + catalogue	Broad consumer goods	Steady, low LS-specific search
YouTube Shopping	Creator + shoppable video	Broad, creator-led	Emerging
StockX Live	Live drops + auctions	Sneakers, apparel, cards	Launches summer 2026
NTWRK	Celebrity drops	Streetwear, sneakers, pop culture	Faded from 2023-24 peak
Palmstreet	Live marketplace	Plants, ceramics, niche collectibles	Breakout from ~zero
TalkShopLive	Host-driven shoppable shows	Books, celebrity, CPG	Niche, partnership-led
Popshop Live (CommentSold)	Live marketplace + SMB tooling	SMB retail, fashion	Consolidating

A few cross-cutting observations:

- **Two super-funnels, many destinations.** TikTok Shop and (to a lesser extent) YouTube and Instagram are where mainstream audiences *discover* live shopping; the category-native marketplaces (Whatnot, Fanatics, eBay Live, Palmstreet) are where committed buyers *transact.* The discovery layer and the destination layer are increasingly distinct businesses.
- **Collectibles is the on-ramp, everything else is the expansion.** Almost every successful destination - Whatnot, Fanatics Live, eBay Live, StockX Live - started in cards/sneakers/ collectibles and is now broad-

ening. The passion vertical builds the daily-active habit; the mass verticals (beauty, fashion, electronics) scale the dollars.

- **Incumbents are re-platforming, not dying.** QVC/HSN's enormous existing audience is being migrated onto streaming, social and a 24/7 TikTok channel. eBay is bolting live onto a marketplace with 30 years of supply. The incumbent advantage is inventory and trust; the challenger advantage is format-native engagement.
- **The toolkit layer is real but quieter.** Behind the destinations sits a B2B enablement layer (CommentSold, Bambuser-style providers, shoppable-video tools). In US *search*, the destination apps dominate - but roughly half of recent live-commerce funding has gone to this infrastructure layer, suggesting investors expect the plumbing to matter as much as the storefronts.

What is growing fastest

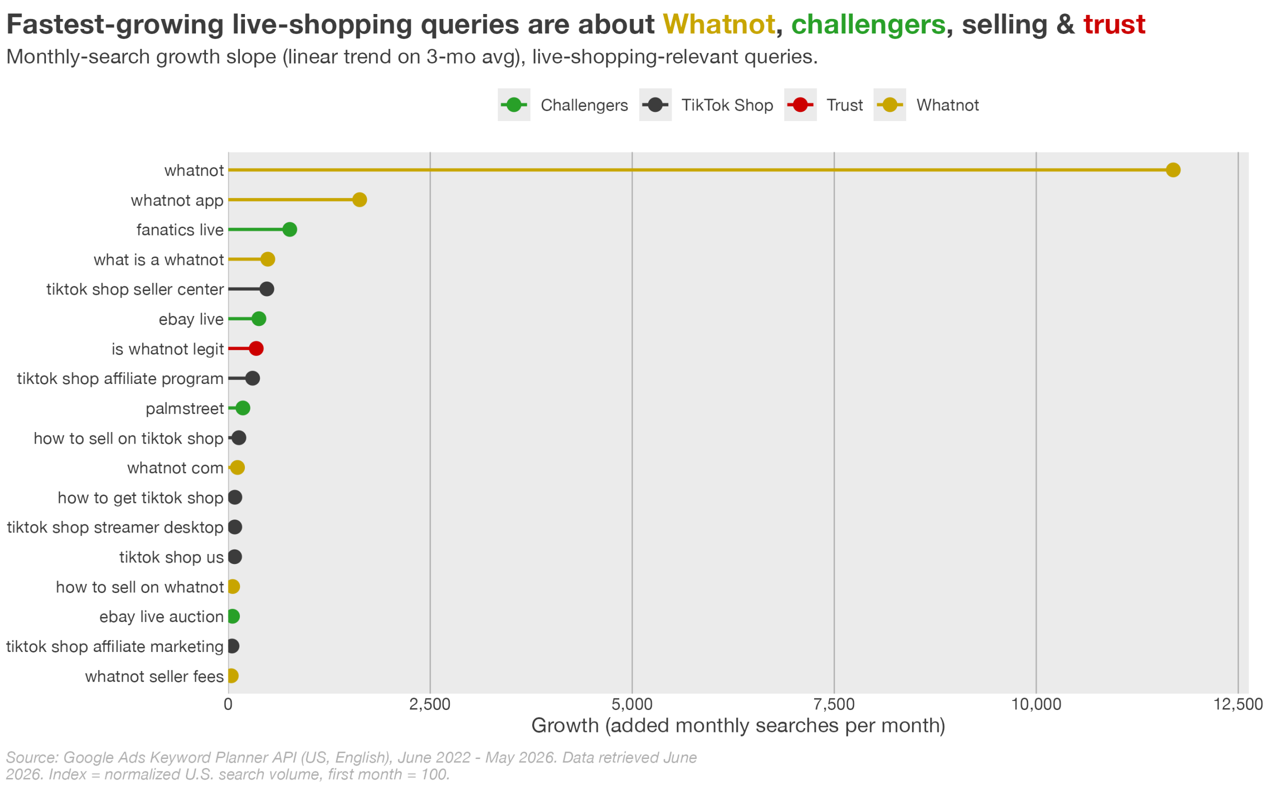

Figure 10: The fastest-growing live-shopping queries, ranked by trend slope (added monthly searches per month). Whatnot, the challengers, seller-intent and trust queries dominate.

Ranking every live-shopping-relevant query by its growth slope (Figure 10) is a compact summary of the whole report. Four themes own the leaderboard:

1. **Whatnot** - the brand and its long tail (*whatnot app*, *what is a whatnot*, *whatnot com*, *whatnot seller fees*).
2. **Challengers** - *fanatics live*, *ebay live*, *palmstreet*, *ebay live auction.*
3. **Selling** - *tiktok shop seller center*, *how to sell on tiktok shop*, *tiktok shop affiliate program*, *how to sell on whatnot.*
4. **Trust** - *is whatnot legit*, *is whatnot app legit.*

That trust queries grow alongside brand and seller queries is the single most interesting cross-cutting finding, and it deserves its own section (see *Trust*, below).

Micro-trends: spotlights from the long tail

The headline indices summarize the category, but the most interesting material is often in the *texture* of the queries - the specific things people type. Below are several themes that surfaced while mining the ~79,000-keyword universe. Some are trending hard, some are flat; all of them are revealing about how Americans actually think about live shopping. (A guiding principle: don't dismiss low monthly volumes - roughly 95% of all search terms get fewer than 10 searches a month, and that long tail is exactly where a trend hides before it is obvious to everyone else.)

What people ask

The question queries are a window into the category's psychology. The two largest - "*what is a whatnot*" and "*is whatnot legit*" - capture the whole arc of a platform going mainstream: first people learn what it is, then they ask whether they can trust it.

Table 5: Sample of question queries (399 in the universe).

Keyword	Avg. monthly searches	4-yr trend
what is a whatnot	22,200	up
is whatnot legit	14,800	up
is tiktok shop legit	5,400	up
what is qvc	4,400	flat
how does tiktok shop work	1,000	flat
is whatnot app legit	1,300	up

Shoppers and sellers compare platforms

Comparison queries are small in volume but disproportionately informative - they show which two options are genuinely in a shopper's consideration set. In live shopping, the comparison that matters is overwhelmingly **Whatnot vs. eBay** - the collectibles incumbent against the live-native challenger.

Table 6: Comparison queries.

Keyword	Avg. monthly searches	4-yr trend
whatnot vs ebay	390	flat
ebay vs whatnot	90	flat
qvc alternative shopping	10	flat

Tools, apps and "how do I go live"

A steady cluster of generic tooling queries - *live shopping platform*, *livestream shopping app* - shows demand from brands and sellers looking for the infrastructure to broadcast, distinct from any single destination app. Whatnot's own app query dwarfs them, a reminder that in the US the destination is winning over the toolkit.

Table 7: Tools / apps / platform queries (245 in the universe).

Keyword	Avg. monthly searches	4-yr trend
whatnot app	90,500	up
hsn app	2,400	flat
live shopping platform	1,900	up
livestream shopping app	1,300	flat
live stream shopping platform	1,300	flat

Trading cards and "breaks": the collectibles engine, in miniature

The collectibles vocabulary is highly fragmented - hundreds of specific, low-volume terms rather than a few big ones. That fragmentation is itself the signal: this is a deep, active community with its own language ("breaks", "rips", specific sets), not a casual audience.

Table 8: Sample of live card-breaking queries.

Keyword	Avg. monthly searches	4-yr trend
whatnot card	480	flat
whatnot sports cards	390	flat
live sports card breaks	320	flat
card breaks live	320	flat

Niche breakouts: plants and thrift go live

Two genuinely new niches show up. **Palmstreet** - live selling of plants, ceramics and niche collectibles - has broken out from near zero, and **"live thrifting"** is emerging as a behaviour in its own right. These are the kind of small, weird, fast-growing signals that tend to precede the next mainstream vertical.

Table 9: Sample of niche-format queries.

Keyword	Avg. monthly searches	4-yr trend
palmstreet	6,600	up
palmstreet app	1,000	up
live thrifting	210	flat

The wave is home-grown, not imported

A useful negative finding: despite China's mature live-commerce market, **US interest in foreign live-shopping platforms is faint.** The Chinese super-apps that dominate live commerce abroad (Douyin, Kuaishou, Taobao Live, Shopee) appear in US search almost entirely as *app-download* curiosity rather than shopping intent, and genuine cross-border live-shopping terms are tiny.

Table 10: US search for international live-commerce apps - mostly download curiosity, not shopping.

Keyword	Avg. monthly searches	4-yr trend
douyin	90,500	up
kuaishou	5,400	up
live shopee	320	flat
taobao live shopping	10	flat

The implication is strategically important: the US live-shopping breakout is **domestically driven** - by TikTok Shop, Whatnot and the collectibles community - not a spillover from Asian platforms. The American market is building its own version rather than importing one.

Whatnot's long tail

Finally, the depth of Whatnot's brand footprint is itself a signal. Beyond the head term, a long tail of intent-rich queries has formed - fees, selling, the company, the website - the kind of vocabulary that only accretes around a platform people are seriously using and seriously considering selling on.

Table 11: A slice of Whatnot's 125-term brand long tail.

Keyword	Avg. monthly searches	4-yr trend
whatnot app	90,500	up
what is a whatnot	22,200	up
whatnot com	6,600	up
whatnot auction	2,900	flat
whatnot fees	1,900	up
whatnot shop	1,900	up
whatnot seller fees	1,600	up

How the questions mature

There is a natural life-cycle to how people search a new category: first *what is it?*, then *is it safe?*, then *how do I do it?* Bucketing live-shopping question queries by type and tracking them over time (Figure 11) shows the US market moving decisively into the third phase.

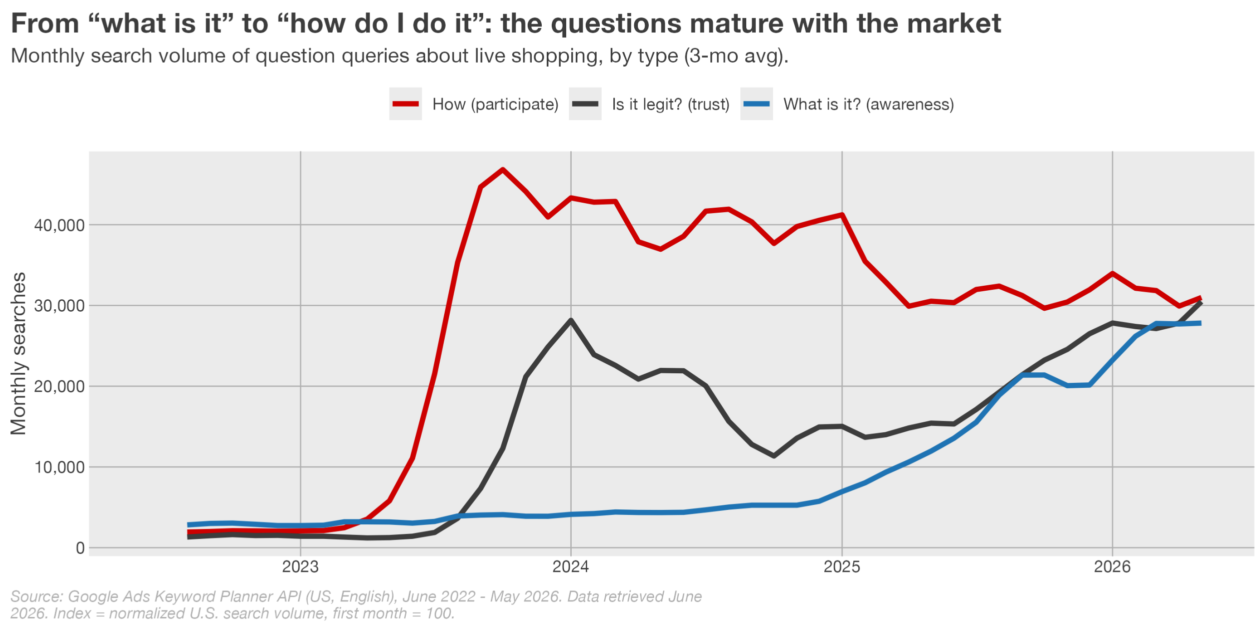

Figure 11: Question queries about live shopping over time, by type. "How" (participation) now dominates "what" (awareness) and "is it legit" (trust).

"How" questions now dominate - averaging nearly 28,000 searches a month versus ~15,000 for trust questions and ~9,000 for "what is it" awareness. This is the signature of a maturing market: the centre of gravity has shifted from *understanding* live shopping to *participating* in it - how to sell, how to use the apps, how to get started. The awareness phase is largely over. The two phases that remain live - participation ("how") and trust ("is it legit") - are the two that platforms can most directly influence, and they are the subject of the next two sections.

Trust: “is it legit?”

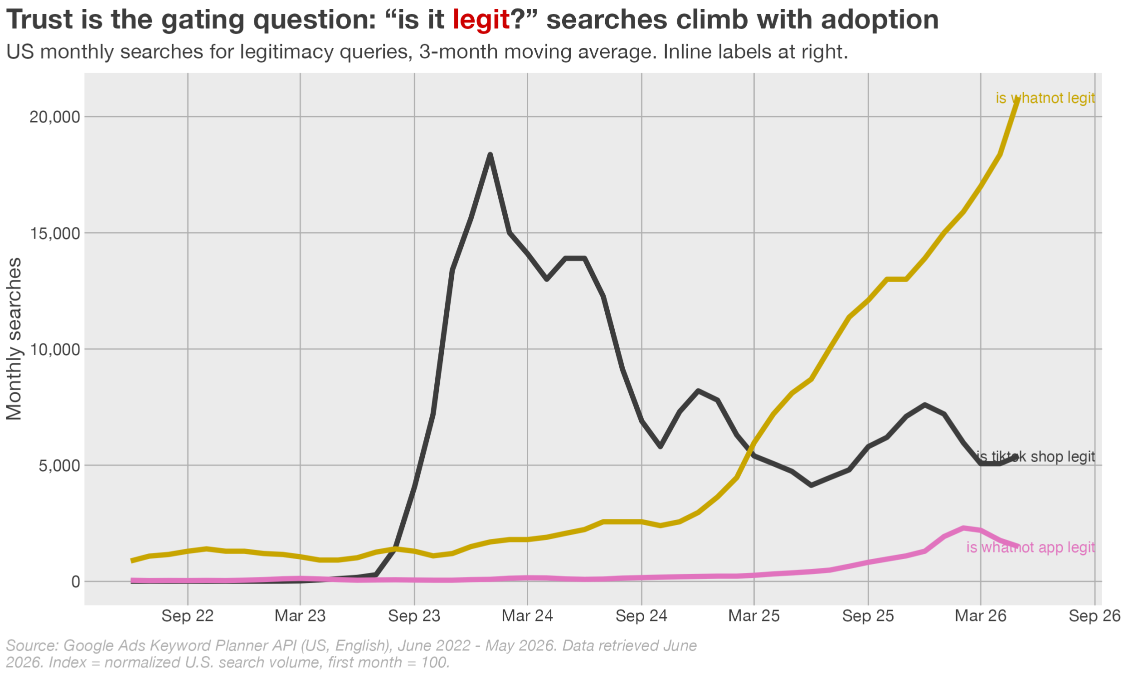

Figure 12: Legitimacy queries scale with adoption. TikTok Shop legitimacy fears spiked after its 2023 US launch then eased; “is whatnot legit” has climbed steadily and now leads.

As live shopping goes mainstream, consumers do something very human: they ask whether they can trust it. Figure 12 tracks legitimacy queries:

- **“Is TikTok Shop legit”** spiked dramatically after the 2023 US launch - a wave of skepticism about a new, unfamiliar, algorithm-driven storefront - then eased as the format became familiar.
- **“Is Whatnot legit”** has climbed steadily and now **leads**, which is exactly what you would expect from a platform moving from niche to mainstream: more new buyers means more first-time due-diligence searches.

The qualitative concerns behind these searches are consistent across platforms: counterfeit or low-quality goods, items that never arrive (often small international sellers), and refund friction. The practical implication for platforms is that **trust infrastructure - verified sellers, buyer protection, transparent fees, dispute resolution - is now a growth lever, not a compliance cost.** Trust questions are not a sign of trouble; they are a sign of scale. But the platform that answers them best will convert the most skeptics.

Vertical breakouts

Two complementary views of “what sells live” emerge from the data.

On the search side, collectibles still lead. Within a live-shopping context, **trading cards and “breaks”** dominate vertical search interest and grew ~135% over the window - the single clearest vertical signal. This is the cultural engine that built Whatnot, Fanatics Live and eBay Live, and it remains the gateway drug into live shopping.

On the GMV side, the mix is broadening fast. Whatnot's own 2025 reporting shows its fastest-growing categories by GMV are now well beyond collectibles:

Category	Whatnot GMV growth (2025, YoY)
Beauty	+791%
Electronics	+444%
Jewelry	+259%
Women's fashion	+223%

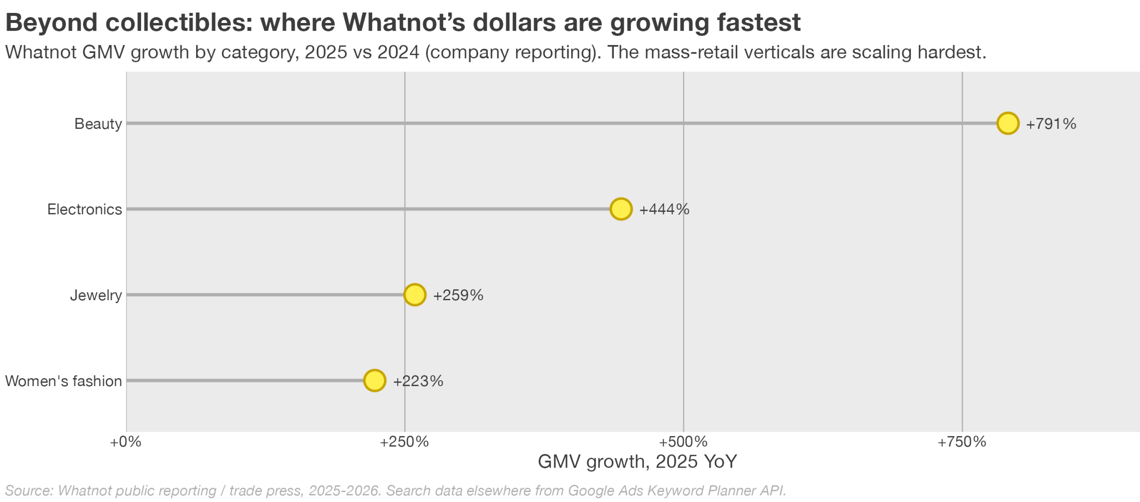

Figure 13: Whatnot GMV growth by category, 2025 vs 2024 (company reporting). The mass-retail verticals - beauty, electronics, jewelry, fashion - are scaling fastest, well beyond the collectibles roots.

The reconciliation between the two views is the insight: **collectibles are the top of the funnel** (they bring passionate, daily-active users in), while **beauty, fashion, electronics and jewelry are where the dollars are scaling**. A platform that converts a card collector into a beauty or fashion buyer captures both the engagement and the basket.

A closer look at the individual verticals:

- **Trading cards & sports memorabilia.** The original engine. The vocabulary is deep and fragmented (*breaks*, *rips*, set-specific terms), signalling a committed community rather than a casual audience. This is where Fanatics Live and eBay Live concentrate, and where Whatnot built its habit. Steady rather than explosive in search - because it is already mature within live shopping.
- **Beauty.** The fastest-growing GMV vertical on Whatnot (+791%) and a natural fit for live demonstration (swatches, tutorials, before/after). Notably, beauty also shows up heavily in **QVC/HSN** search (*qvc makeup*, *qvc skincare*) - the legacy networks' historical strength, now being carried into live-social. Beauty is the clearest example of live shopping crossing from hobbyist niche to mass retail.
- **Women's fashion & apparel.** Whatnot's fastest-growing *segment*, with individual sellers reportedly crossing $1M/month via clothing hauls and liquidation streams. Apparel suits the format's impulse-and-

scarcity dynamics (limited sizes, "going once"), and resale/thrift gives it a sustainability angle that resonates with younger buyers.

- **Electronics & gadgets.** +444% GMV on Whatnot and a staple of TikTok Shop's deal-driven feed. Lower emotional engagement than collectibles, but high basket sizes and strong promotional response.
- **Jewelry & watches.** +259% GMV on Whatnot; eBay Live's expansion into luxury watches and handbags targets exactly this. High average order values make even modest volumes lucrative.
- **Plants, ceramics & "weird niches."** The frontier. Palmstreet's breakout shows that almost any passionate collecting community can support a live marketplace - the model generalizes wherever there is a hobby, a community, and items worth showing in real time.

Live auctions: a parallel format

A distinct but related behaviour runs underneath the headline trend: **live auctions**. Bid-based, time-pressured, collectibles-led selling (cards, sneakers, coins, comics, Funko) shows up in queries like *ebay live auction* and underpins much of Whatnot's and Fanatics Live's engagement. Auctions carry a different psychology from fixed-price live shopping - higher intensity, social competition, and a "win" payoff - and they map onto the same collectibles verticals that lead the category. StockX Live's 2026 entry is explicitly auction-and-drop flavoured. Auctions are worth tracking as a leading indicator: they tend to attract the most engaged users first.

Table 12: Sample of live-auction queries (334 in the universe). Note that some "live auction" terms also refer to offline auctions.

Keyword	Avg. monthly searches	4-yr trend
live auction	40,500	down
ebay live auction	2,900	up
live auction sites	2,400	up
live auction app	720	flat
whatnot live auction	390	flat
live bidding	260	flat

The split mirrors the platform story: the generic, partly-offline "*live auction*" term drifts down, while the **platform-attached** auction terms (*ebay live auction*, *whatnot live auction*) and the app/sites queries rise. Auctions are not fading; they are **moving onto live-commerce platforms.**

The long tail: where tomorrow's trends hide

A recurring theme of this research is that the interesting signal is rarely in the head terms. Roughly **95% of all search queries** (across every topic, not just this one) get fewer than ten searches a month. In an emerging category, that long tail is not noise to be discarded - it is the leading edge, the place where a behaviour is visible before it has a name.

The table below mixes mid-volume and very-low-volume live-shopping terms to make the point. A term like *taobao live shopping* (10/month) is a faint echo of the mature Chinese market; *live thrifting* and *whatnot live auction* are small today but describe behaviours that could be large tomorrow.

Table 13: A walk down the long tail.

Keyword	Avg. monthly searches	4-yr trend
whatnot auction	2,900	flat
palmstreet app	1,000	up
live sports card breaks	320	flat
how to start selling on whatnot	260	flat
live thrifting	210	flat
whatnot live auction	390	flat
taobao live shopping	10	flat

The practical implication: anyone trying to ride this category - a brand, a platform, a host - should be watching the sub-100-searches-a-month terms, because by the time a query is large, the opportunity to be early is gone.

Where the opportunities are

The search data does not just describe the market; it hints at gaps. A few opportunities that fall out of the patterns above (offered as prompts, not predictions):

- **Multi-platform "go live once" tooling.** Sellers increasingly search across Whatnot, TikTok Shop, eBay Live and others. Tooling that lets a host broadcast to several platforms at once while keeping chat and cart unified addresses a real, visible pain.
- **A "live selling starter kit."** The surge in *how to sell* / *seller fees* queries reveals a wave of aspiring sellers who lack training and basic gear. Education plus a simple equipment bundle is a natural product.
- **Brand-to-platform (and brand-to-host) matching.** With the platform landscape fragmenting into category-native lanes, brands need help picking the right platform and the right host for their vertical - a curation/matchmaking opportunity.
- **Trust as a product.** Because "is it legit?" scales with adoption, verification, buyer-protection and transparent-fee features are not just compliance - they are a differentiator a platform or third party can build around.

Beyond search: corroborating signals and global context

Search interest is one lens; it is more convincing when other signals point the same way.

Other attention signals agree. Whatnot's rise is mirrored in YouTube search, Reddit activity, and Wikipedia pageviews - all "up and to the right." The same holds for the category broadly: live-shopping subreddits have grown, creator content explaining "how to sell on TikTok Shop / Whatnot" has proliferated, and the trade press now covers the space as a category rather than a curiosity. When independent attention signals move together, the underlying shift is more likely real than an artefact of one data source.

Business metrics agree. The search inflection is matched by hard numbers: Whatnot's GMV roughly doubling to $6B+, TikTok Shop's US GMV rising to ~$15B, eBay Live's geographic expansion, StockX's decision to build a live product, and QVC Group's strategic (if financially strained) pivot. Search led; the dollars followed.

Global context: the ceiling is high. In China, live commerce is estimated to account for roughly **60% of e-commerce**; in the US, the figure is around **5%**. Whether or not the US ever approaches Chinese penetration, the gap frames the opportunity: even a partial convergence implies years of structural growth. The US is also taking a recognisably different path - community-and-collectibles-led, and domestically built - rather than copying the Chinese super-app model wholesale.

Risks: what could derail the breakout

The base case is constructive, but a credible report names the ways it could be wrong.

- **Trust erosion at scale.** The biggest risk is the flip side of the biggest opportunity. If counterfeits, non-delivery, and refund friction grow faster than verification and buyer protection, the "is it legit?" question could curdle from healthy curiosity into mainstream distrust - the one thing that reliably kills a nascent consumer behaviour.
- **TikTok execution risk.** The ownership question is resolved, but the new US joint venture still has to run a complex marketplace, keep creators and sellers engaged, and grow the *live* share of GMV (still only ~14%). Missteps at the largest discovery funnel would slow the whole category.
- **Seller economics and churn.** The supply surge is real, but live selling is hard work with thin margins for many. If aspiring sellers churn out faster than they are recruited - or if fee changes sour sentiment (note the rising *seller fees* queries) - the supply engine could stall.
- **Concentration risk.** Whatnot's dominance is a strength and a fragility: a single platform carrying so much of the category's momentum means its stumbles would be the category's stumbles.
- **Macro and attention competition.** Live shopping competes for discretionary spend and, just as critically, for attention. A consumer pullback or a shift in where people spend their screen time would pressure a format that depends on both.

What it means - by stakeholder

The same data reads differently depending on where you sit. A consolidated view:

For platforms and marketplaces

- **Win a community before a category.** Every durable destination started by owning a passionate vertical, then expanded. Generic "live video + cart" has repeatedly failed; community-native formats have repeatedly won.
- **Treat trust as a product, not a policy.** "Is it legit?" scales with adoption; the platform that most visibly solves verification, buyer protection and dispute resolution converts the most skeptics into buyers.

For incumbent retailers and brands

- **Re-platform; don't wait to be displaced.** QVC/HSN's migration onto streaming, social and a 24/7 TikTok channel shows incumbents can convert legacy audiences - the rising "official site"/app search proves the audience is willing to move.
- **Match the platform to the vertical.** The landscape is a federation of lanes (cards to Fanatics/eBay, beauty/fashion to TikTok Shop and Whatnot, drops to NTWRK's successors). There is no single "live shopping channel" to plug into.
- **The mass verticals are the prize.** Beauty, electronics, jewelry and fashion are scaling fastest by GMV - the dollars have moved well beyond the collectibles roots.

For sellers and creators

- **You are early.** The seller ecosystem is forming now. The surge in "how to sell" queries is your competition arriving - but the audience is arriving faster.
- **Mind the economics.** Rising "seller fees" searches signal that take-rates and margins are front of mind. Platform choice is increasingly an economic decision, not just an audience one.

For investors and analysts

- **Watch the live-selling index as the leading dashboard** - it leads consumer interest by roughly two quarters.
- **Distinguish the flash from the floor.** Event spikes (the TikTok ban) mostly revert; the durable signal is the rising baseline.

What search data can - and cannot - tell you

In the spirit of intellectual honesty, it is worth being explicit about the method's limits.

What it does well. Search is an unbiased, real-time, behavioural signal. Nobody searches to please a pollster. It captures *latent demand* (people considering live shopping before they buy), *supply intent* (people learning to sell before they are onboarded), and *trust friction* (people checking legitimacy before they commit) - often months before any of these show up in GMV. Because it is continuous and granular, it surfaces micro-trends (Palmstreet, "live thrifting") while they are still tiny.

What it cannot do. Search interest is attention, not transactions: a query is not a sale, and the relationship between the two varies by category. Keyword Planner volumes are *bucketed* (reported in bands), so absolute numbers are best read as orders of magnitude. Brand search and category search can diverge - as Whatnot shows - so any single basket undercounts the platforms that have become verbs. And search cannot explain *why*: it can show that "is whatnot legit" is rising, but not what specifically reassures or alarms a shopper. The right posture is to treat search as a **leading, directional indicator** to be triangulated against GMV, funding, app rankings and qualitative research - which is exactly how this report uses it.

Outlook and implications

The base case for 2026-27 is continued, structurally higher growth. The category cleared three overhangs at once: Meta's exit is fully digested, TikTok's ownership question is resolved, and a category-native champion (Whatnot) has both the GMV trajectory and the capital to keep expanding. Search interest sits on a higher plateau, the supply side is heating up faster than the demand side, and incumbents (QVC/HSN) are re-platforming rather than disappearing.

What to watch:

- **Can supply scale with trust intact?** The gating risk is no longer demand - it is whether platforms can grow sellers and inventory without letting counterfeits, non-delivery and refund friction erode the trust that adoption depends on.
- **Does the vertical mix keep broadening?** If beauty, fashion and electronics keep compounding the way collectibles did, live shopping graduates from a hobbyist niche to a mainstream retail channel.
- **TikTok Shop's live mix.** Livestreams are still a minority of TikTok Shop GMV (~14% in 2025 vs ~10% in 2024); if that share climbs now that the ownership question is settled, it would meaningfully lift the whole category.
- **The challengers' lanes.** Fanatics Live, eBay Live, Palmstreet and the incoming StockX Live suggest the future is a **federation of category-native live marketplaces**, not a single winner-take-all app.

The one-line takeaway: **US live shopping in 2026 is no longer a question of "if" - it is a question of how fast supply and trust can scale to meet demand that has already inflected.**

A watchlist for 2026-27

If this report were a dashboard, these are the dials worth checking each quarter - chosen because each one is an early, decision-relevant signal rather than a lagging headline:

Table 14: A quarterly watchlist of leading signals.

Signal	Why it matters	What would change the story
Live-selling index	Leads consumer interest by ~2 quarters	A sustained roll-over would warn of a slowdown before GMV shows it
TikTok Shop live-GMV share	Live is still only ~14% of its GMV	A rising live share would lift the whole category
StockX Live launch (summer 2026)	A credible, capitalised new entrant	Fast search traction would validate the auction-and-drops model
New-entrant pipeline	Palmstreet showed the lane is open	The next near-zero breakout is the next Palmstreet
“Is it legit?” trajectory	Trust gates mainstream adoption	A sharp acceleration would flag a trust problem at scale
Seller-fee / seller-economics queries	Supply is the constraint	Rising discontent would threaten the supply engine
QVC Group post-restructuring	Test of incumbent re-platforming	Success or failure here generalises to all legacy retail

Taken together, these dials describe a category that has cleared its existential questions and now turns on execution: **scaling supply and trust.** The demand has already inflected; 2026-27 will be decided by how well the industry meets it.

Appendix

Methodology details

- **Source:** Google Ads Keyword Planner API (keyword ideas + historical metrics), US (location 2840), English (language 1000).
- **Window:** June 2022 - May 2026 (48 months), retrieved June 2026. The Keyword Planner returns a rolling 48-month window; the analysis uses only that fresh window and splices in no older data.
- **Seeds -> universe:** ~7,700 curated seeds (covering established and emerging platforms and verticals) expanded to ~257,000 raw ideas, de-duplicated (including metric-identical keyword collisions) to ~79,000 unique keywords with complete 48-month histories.
- **Indices:** the Live Shopping basket matches *live shop*, *livestream shop*, *live commerce*, *live stream shop*, *livestream commerce*; the Live Selling basket matches *live sell*. Monthly volumes are summed across the basket and normalized so the first month = 100. Charts use a right-aligned 3-month moving average.
- **Trend stats:** per-keyword 3-month rolling average and an OLS linear trend (slope, R-squared) on keywords with a meaningful signal (max monthly volume > 20, fewer than 47 zero months).
- **Exclusions:** known bot-inflated terms are removed; international markets are out of scope.
- **Theme tables:** keyword samples in the micro-trend tables are drawn from the cleaned universe by topic pattern and shown with average monthly searches and a "4-yr trend" label derived from the linear-trend slope (up / flat / down). Samples are curated for relevance and are illustrative, not exhaustive; volumes are Keyword Planner buckets.

The data funnel

The universe was built in stages, each one narrowing toward signal:

Table 15: The seed-to-index funnel.

Stage	Count	What it is
Curated seeds	~7,700	Seeds covering established and emerging platforms and verticals
Raw keyword ideas	~257,000	Google's keyword-ideas expansion of those seeds
Unique keywords (cleaned)	~79,000	After de-duplication, including metric-identical collisions
Modelable keywords	~57,000	After dropping near-zero / sparse series
Live-shopping basket	~196	Index constituents matching the live-shopping pattern
Live-selling basket	~107	Index constituents matching the live-selling pattern

The index basket

The live-shopping index is built from queries that explicitly express live-shopping intent. They fall into five broad groups (with representative examples):

- **Definitions & concepts** - *live shopping*, *livestream shopping*, *live commerce*, *what is live shopping*.
- **Social platforms** - *tiktok live shopping*, *instagram live shopping*, *youtube live shopping*, *facebook live shopping*.
- **How-to & tools** - *live shopping app*, *live shopping platform*, *live stream shopping platform.*
- **Retailers & marketplaces** - *whatnot live shopping*, *amazon live shopping*, *qvc live shopping*, *hsn live shopping*, *ebay live shopping*.
- **Software providers** - vendor-named live-shopping tooling (e.g. *bambuser live shopping*).

Standalone brand terms (e.g. "whatnot" on its own) sit *outside* this intent basket by design, which is why brand-level analyses in this report are run separately from the index.

Glossary

- **Live shopping / live commerce** - real-time, video-led selling where a host presents products to a live audience that can buy, bid, and chat in the moment.
- **Live selling** - the seller-side of the same activity; the act of hosting and selling on a live stream.
- **GMV (gross merchandise value)** - the total value of goods sold through a platform; the standard scale metric for marketplaces.
- **Break / card break** - a live event where a host opens sealed trading-card product and distributes cards to buyers who purchased slots; a core collectibles format.
- **Drop** - a scheduled release of limited-quantity items, often with scarcity and hype (streetwear, sneakers, collectibles).
- **Search-interest index** - here, normalized total monthly Google search volume across a curated basket of queries, set to 100 in the first month of the window.
- **Slope (trend)** - the average monthly change in a keyword's smoothed search volume, used to rank growth.
- **Head term / long tail** - high-volume general queries (head) versus the vast number of low-volume specific queries (long tail), where early signals often appear first.

Caveats

Search interest is a proxy for attention, not a direct measure of sales. Absolute Keyword Planner volumes are bucketed and should be read as orders of magnitude. GMV, funding and event figures are drawn from public reporting and company statements (see sources) and are estimates.

Selected sources

- **Whatnot** (GMV, valuation, categories, engagement): Business of Fashion; Digital Commerce 360; Tech-Funding News; Sacra; Fortune; Marketplace Pulse; FashionNetwork; Whatnot 2026 trends.
- **TikTok Shop** (US GMV, sellers, live mix): Momentum Works / The Low Down; FastMoss; Statista; Marketing LTB.
- **TikTok ownership deal** (Jan 2026 USDS joint venture): TechCrunch; Marketplace; Retail TouchPoints.
- **QVC Group** (rebrand, TikTok channel, Chapter 11): QVC Group SEC 8-K filings (CIK 1355096).
- **Challengers** (StockX Live, Fanatics Live, eBay Live, Popshop/CommentSold): PR Newswire; WWD; CNBC; Value Added Resource; Retail Dive.

- **Market size / adoption / trust**: GetStream; Grand View Research; Statista; eMarketer; consumer-trust coverage (Surfshark, TrustDALE, Avast, University of Kentucky ITS).

Reproducible code and data pipeline: project repository (`pipeline-2026/`, `report-2026/`).